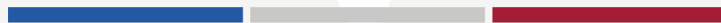




MIT SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
MIT SCHWARZMAN COLLEGE OF COMPUTING



ORIENTATION MODULE UNIT 1
Media Set Video 2 Transcript

Orientation Module Unit 1 Media Set Video 2 Transcript

The learning journey

PAUL MCDONAGH-SMITH: Our three modules map to key questions that every leader needs to answer about Agentic AI. For instance, what is it? And where could it matter? How do we operationalize it responsibly? And when and how should we scale it?

The sequence is deliberate. Each module builds on what came before, and the progression itself reflects how thoughtful organizations should approach agentic adoption. Let me walk you through what's ahead.

Module 1 gives you the conceptual foundations. Before you can make good decisions about agents, you need to understand what they actually are and what they're not. We'll position Agentic AI on the broader AI continuum, from the rule-based systems of the 1950s, through machine learning and deep learning, to today's generative AI. And then beyond to the frontier where AI systems shift from reactive to proactive. You'll learn what distinguishes an agent from a chatbot. The capacity to plan, to use tools, to pursue goals across multiple steps, to operate with a degree of autonomy that changes the nature of the leadership challenge entirely.

Module 2 is where we move from "What is it?" to "How does it actually work?" We'll go inside the agent loop, how agents plan, how they act, how they observe results, and how they iterate. We'll explore why and when organizations move from single agents to multi-agent systems and what orchestrating a team of AI agents actually demands.

And then in Module 3, we'll look at scaling Agentic AI. We'll confront the question that separates experimentation from real enterprise impact. And it's fundamentally a question about governance, risk, and trust. Notice the arc. We move from understanding what Agentic AI is and where it creates value; to architecture: how you design, scaffold, and orchestrate Agentic systems; to strategy: how you scale responsibly, govern confidently, and connect initiative to enterprise value.

Explore, implement, scale. That's the progression. And at each stage, you're not just learning concepts, you're building a deliverable that applies directly to your organization. Agentic AI isn't coming, it's here. The question isn't whether autonomous agents will reshape how your organization operates, it's whether you'll be the one shaping how that happens, or whether you'll be responding to decisions that others have already made in your industry.

This course is designed to give you the clarity, the frameworks, and the practical tools to lead that transformation. Not as a technologist, but as a technology-enabled executive who understands what these systems can do, what they can't, and what responsible deployment really requires. The journey starts now. Let's begin with Module 1.

SPEAKER: Did you understand all the concepts covered in this video? If you'd like to review any of the content, please click on the chapter menu.